



R. V. MOORTHY

had been a sense that Elavenil had something special. She has been competing internationally since 2018, when she was 18, and has since won medals at the Asian Championships, World Cups, World Cup Finals and World Championships.

She has also represented India at three major multi-sport Games: the

2018 Asian Games in Jakarta, the Tokyo Olympics in 2021 and the 2024 Paris Games.

Yet she had never had a medal from one of them to show for it. At all three, she failed to make it beyond the qualification round.

There was more than enough time, then, for memories of those disappointments to flood back

during the one-and-a-half-hour drive from her team hotel in the port city of Nagoya, through winding hairpin bends and up into the hills towards the Shooting Range.

Instead, she looked out at the verdant mountainside and put on her earphones. Her playlist was a smorgasbord of Western rock, Punjabi belters, Bollywood hits and